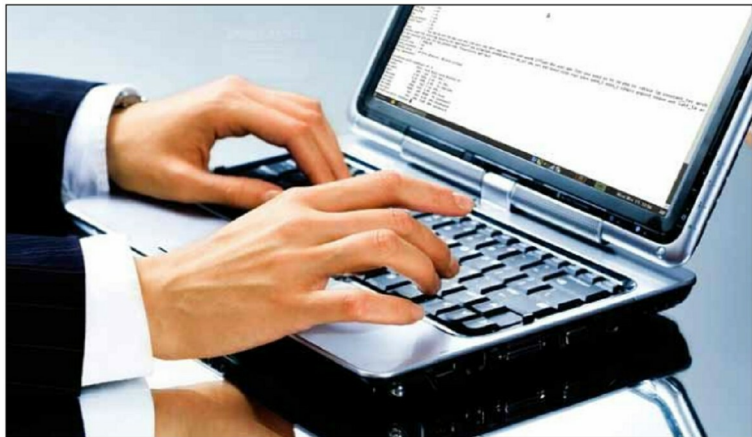


Know Your Linux System

Users trying out a Linux system after using Windows, generally struggle to get system status and other information. There are several commands to get system information including hardware versions, the distribution of the OS, details about the disk space, memory, etc. This article is a concise compilation of the most commonly required commands.



To begin with, you can use the following command to know which distribution you are using:

```
cat /etc/issue
```

One easy way to quickly find out about the details of the running system, including the name of the kernel version, the release level, distribution name, CPU, network node host name, etc, is to use the `uname` command. You can use the various options to display specific information like the kernel name (`-s`), kernel release (`-r`), kernel version (`-v`), host name (`-n`) and machine hardware name (`-m`). The `uname -a` command will display all the information:

```
[root@sys70 ~]# uname -a
Linux sys70 2.6.18-348.1.1.el5xen #1 SMP Tue Jan 22 17:49:28
EST 2013 i686 i686 i386 GNU/Linux
```

If you want to display all partitions on your system, use `fdisk -l`:

```
[root@sys70 ~]# fdisk -l
Disk /dev/hda: 250.0 GB, 250059350016 bytes
255 heads, 63 sectors/track, 30401 cylinders
Units = cylinders of 10065 * 512 = 8225280 bytes
```

Device	Boot	Start	End	Blocks	Id	System
/dev/hda1	*	1	13	104391	83	Linux
/dev/hda2		14	30401	244091610	8e	Linux LVM

The `free` command gives information about the memory, including the total memory, free memory and swap space used in the system, in KB, by default. The `-m` or `-g` option can be used to display information in MB or GB. The first line shows the RAM used, the second line shows the amount of memory occupied by system buffer cache, and the third line shows the total swap space and what's currently available.

```
[root@sys70 ~]# free -m
total    used    free    shared    buffers    cached
Mem: 1722  1366   355      0       132      797
```